retired head of the Israeli army's strategic division (and Isaac's brother). "It's carried out by young people… it's protracted, it's not really organized, and it's difficult to stop."

An intifada

"Intifada" is often translated as "uprising", though it comes from an Arabic root, *nafada*, meaning "to shake off". One of its first public appearances in the Palestinian context came in December of 1987, in the inaugural communiqué from a then-nascent Islamist group called Hamas. "The intifada of our vigilant people in the occupied territories is a resounding rejection of the occupation," it said.

The first intifada, which would continue until the early 1990s, was a grassroots movement over which the PLO had limited control. Its early leadership was a loose coalition of activists and intellectuals. They focused largely on nonviolent tactics—economic boycotts and civil disobedience. Some Palestinians also threw stones and Molotov cocktails at the Israeli army in the occupied West Bank. Compared to the second intifada, though, the Palestinian violence was limited: there was only one suicide attack (an Islamic Jihad operative who seized the wheel of a passenger bus and drove it off a cliff) from 1989 until mid-1993.

Israel nonetheless responded harshly, with what Defense Minister Yitzhak Rabin called the "broken bones" policy, ordering security forces to shatter the limbs of protesters. More than 1,500 Palestinians were killed, tens of thousands were wounded, and some 120,000 were jailed. Israeli troops demolished homes, uprooted trees, and deported dozens of prominent Palestinian activists. These images of widespread violence, of soldiers harshly beating teenage protesters, dealt a blow to Israel's international standing. For the first (and last) time, Jerusalem was forced to respond with meaningful overtures—a 1989 peace proposal, the 1991 Madrid conference, and eventually the Oslo Accords, which afforded the Palestinians a limited degree of autonomy in the territories and promised an end to the conflict within five years.

The uprising's successor was equally momentous, though it had the opposite effect. Starting in 2000, four years of attacks killed some 1,000 Israelis, the majority of them civilians. Heavy fighting took place in the urban centers of the West Bank: Jenin was besieged for weeks in 2002, and